ByAuthorX at a glance

Flowcharts and guides for writers. Your words. Your call.



Write. Review. Make it yours.

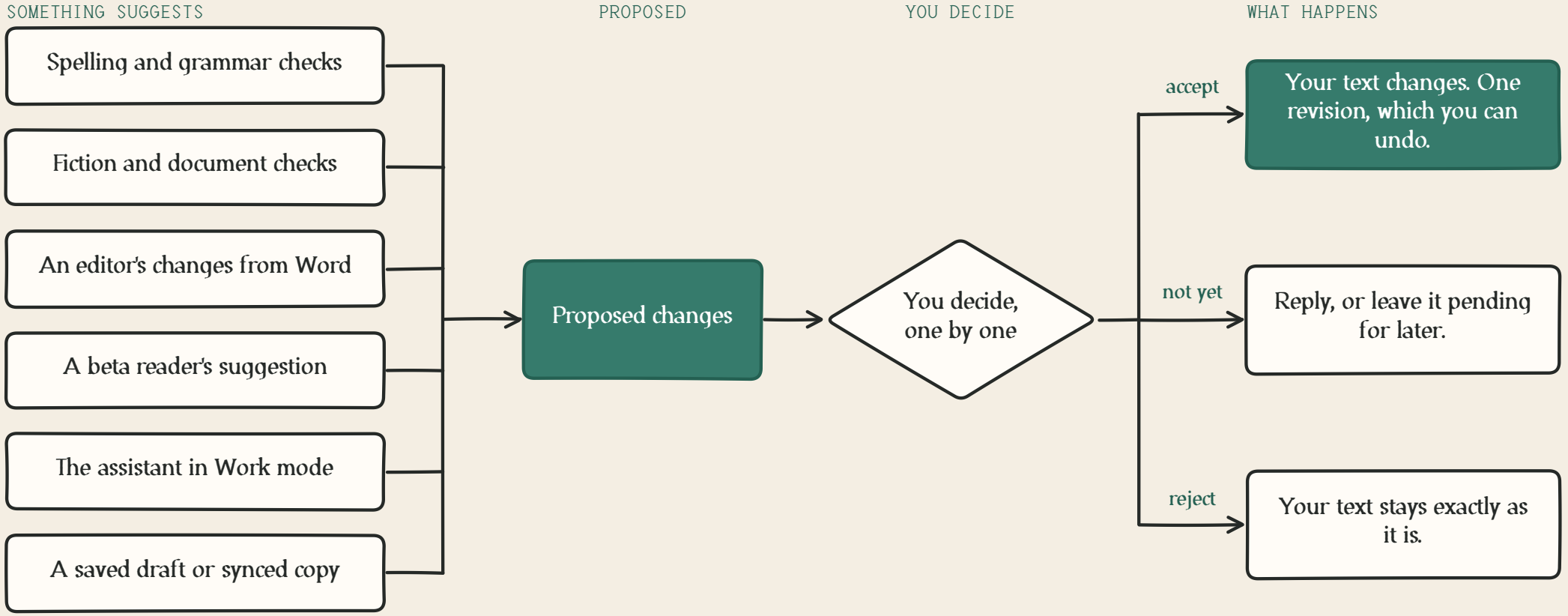
What is inside

Five flowcharts and five guides. Each page also stands alone as a PNG.

3	Nothing changes your text until you accept it	Flowchart
4	What the assistant sees for each request	Flowchart
5	How do I share this?	Flowchart
6	From manuscript to book	Flowchart
7	AI is opt-in, not opt-out	Flowchart
8	Two computers, one manuscript	Flowchart
9	Meet the context engine	Guide
10	Use the context engine	Guide
11	Find your way around the window	Guide
12	Your first minutes	Guide
13	Checks at a glance	Guide
14	Your file, your copies	Guide
15	Private by default	Guide

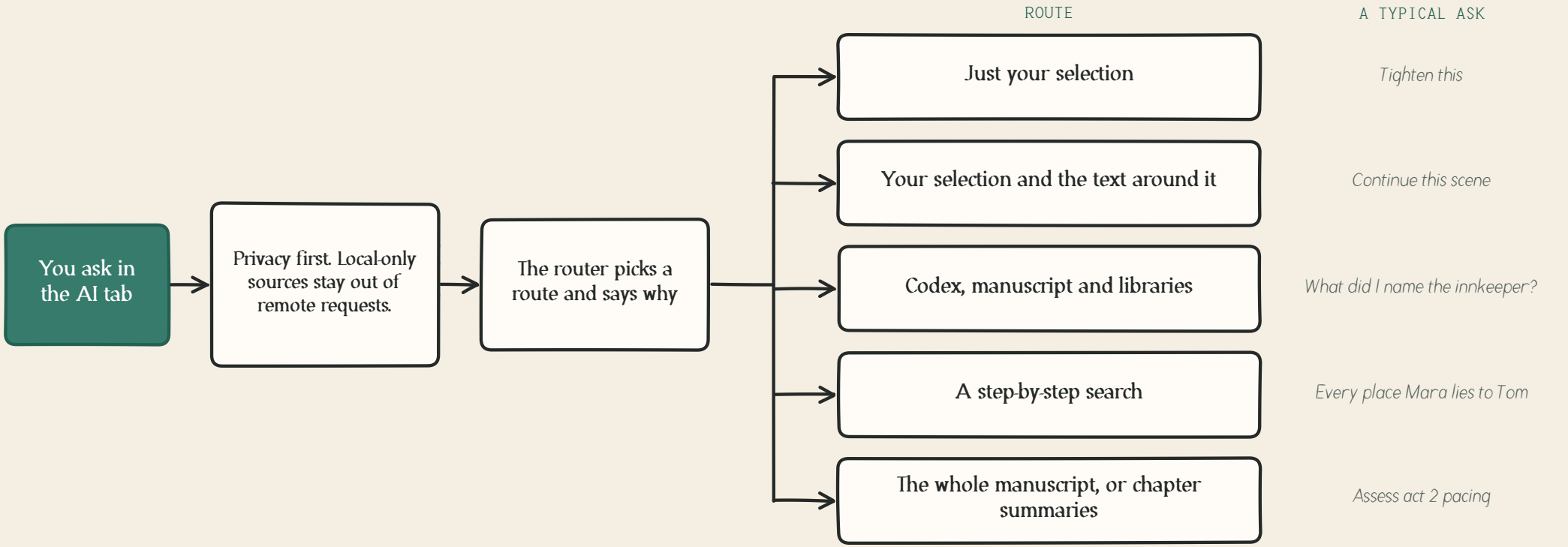
Nothing changes your text until you accept it

Everything that wants to change your writing arrives as a proposal first.



What the assistant sees for each request

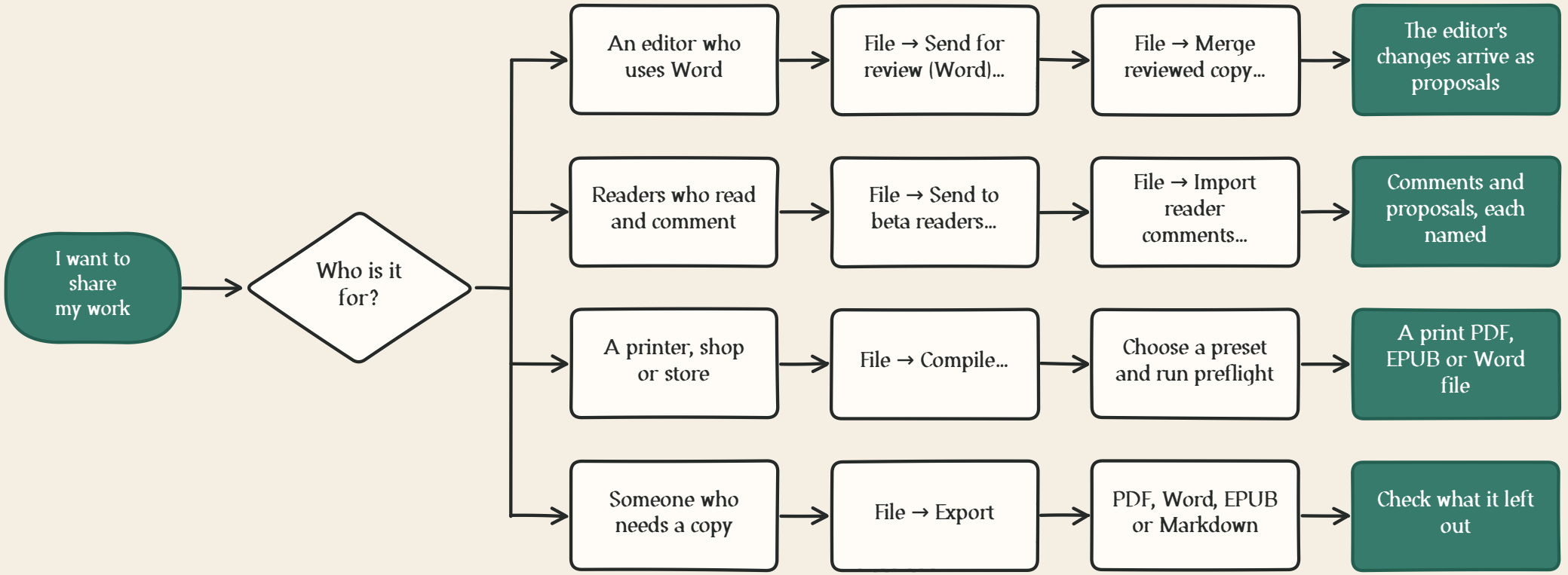
The context engine sends only what a question needs, says why, and lets you look.



Open What the AI saw to read the route, the reason and every item. Pin it, exclude it, or exclude it and ask again.

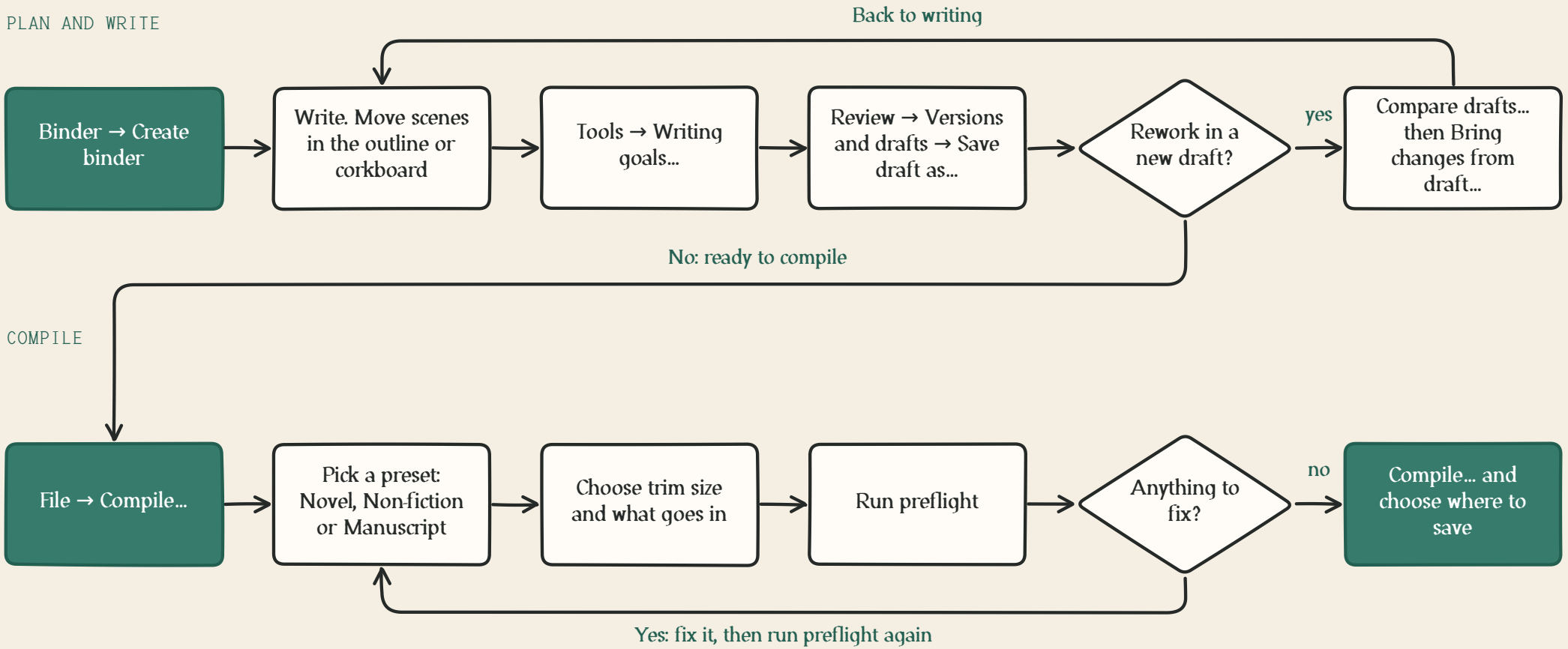
How do I share this?

Your master never leaves your computer unless you send it. Every route makes a copy.



From manuscript to book

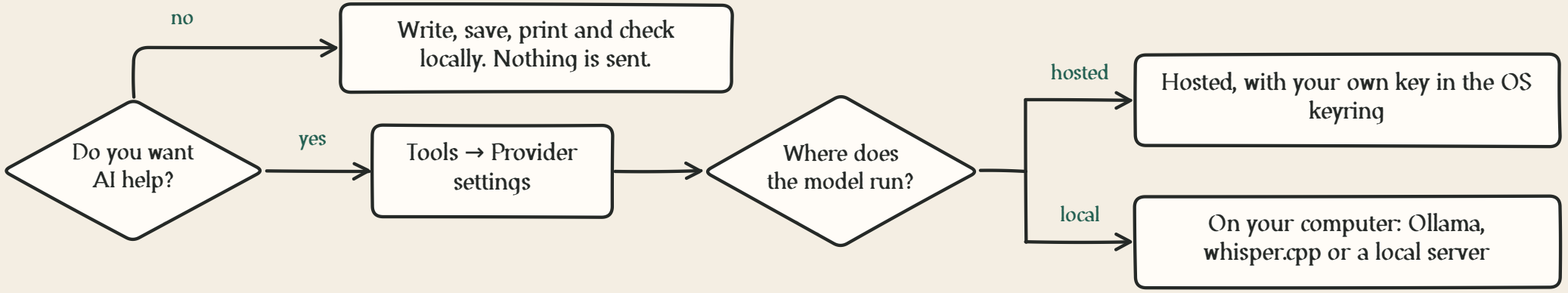
Your master is never changed by a compile. Each format tells you what it could not carry.



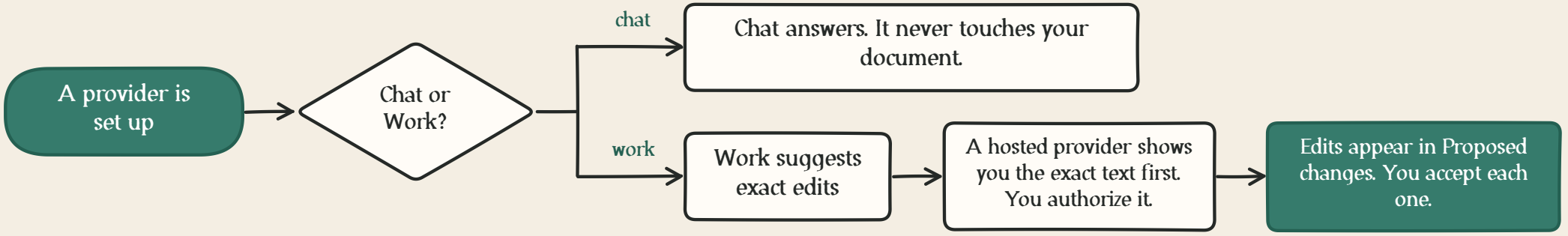
AI is opt-in, not opt-out

No account, no telemetry, no background network traffic. You choose the provider and the moment.

SET UP



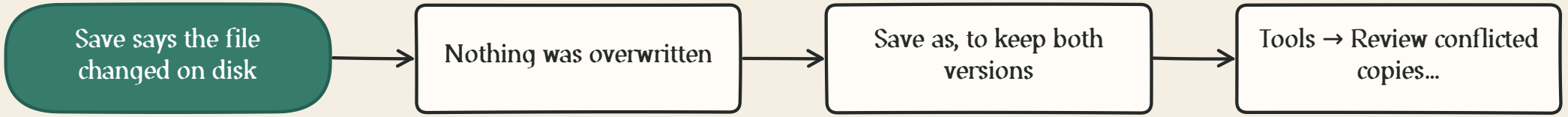
USE IT



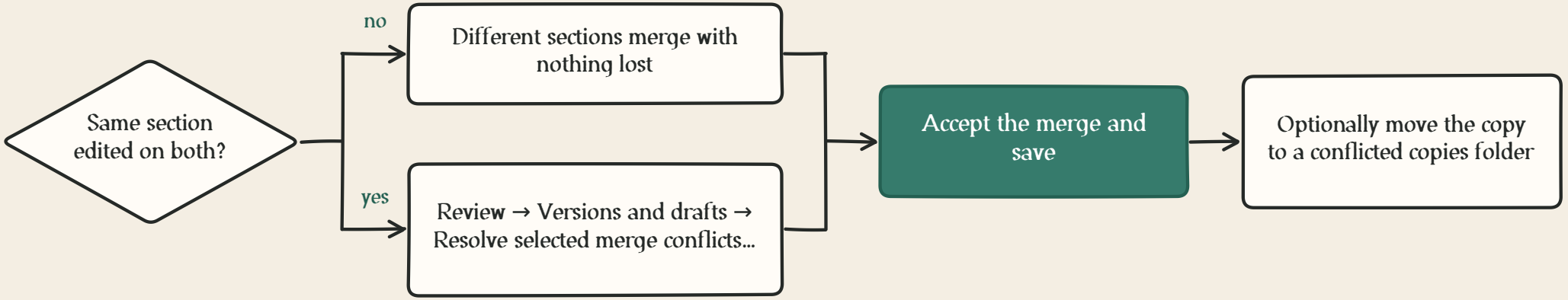
Two computers, one manuscript

Work on one computer at a time. If both edited, you review the merge. Nothing is deleted.

WHEN A SAVE IS REFUSED



REVIEW THE OTHER COPY



Meet the context engine

Answers about your own work that you can find, check and trust.



Found

It searches your manuscript, codex and research on this computer. Exact phrases, excluded words and near words all work.



Checked

Citations open at the page you recorded. Quotations are checked against their source. "Not in your sources" is only said after a literal search.



Shown

For every request you see the route, the reason and each passage the assistant saw. Pin it, leave it out, or ask again without it.



Private first

Local-only libraries never reach a remote model. Codex entries marked Hide from AI are never sent. Nothing is sent until you choose a provider.

Search, codex and the citation audit work with no AI at all.

Use the context engine

Four steps. Search, codex and the citation audit need no AI; the assistant needs a provider you choose.

1 Add your sources

Tools → Libraries attaches research folders. Tools → Codex… keeps characters and places. Mark a library local-only, or an entry Hide from AI.

2 Ask in the AI tab

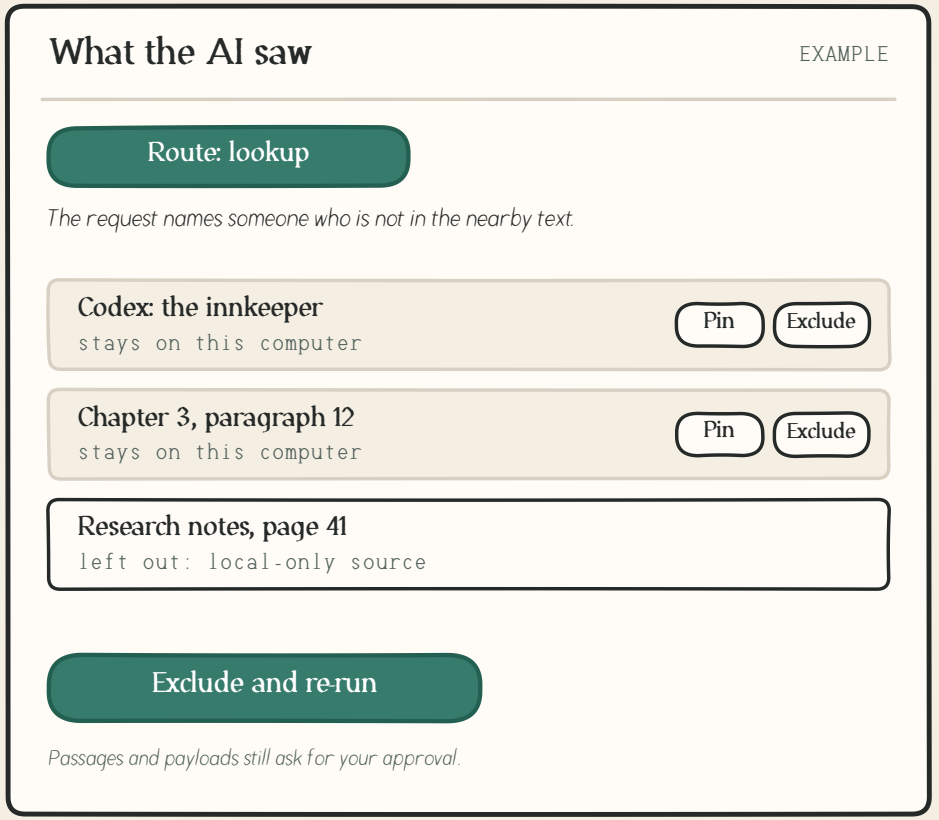
Choose a provider and Chat or Work, then Send. The route and the reason appear under the message box.

3 Open What the AI saw

Read every item with its size and where it went. Pin it, Exclude it, or Exclude and re-run.

4 Check the citations

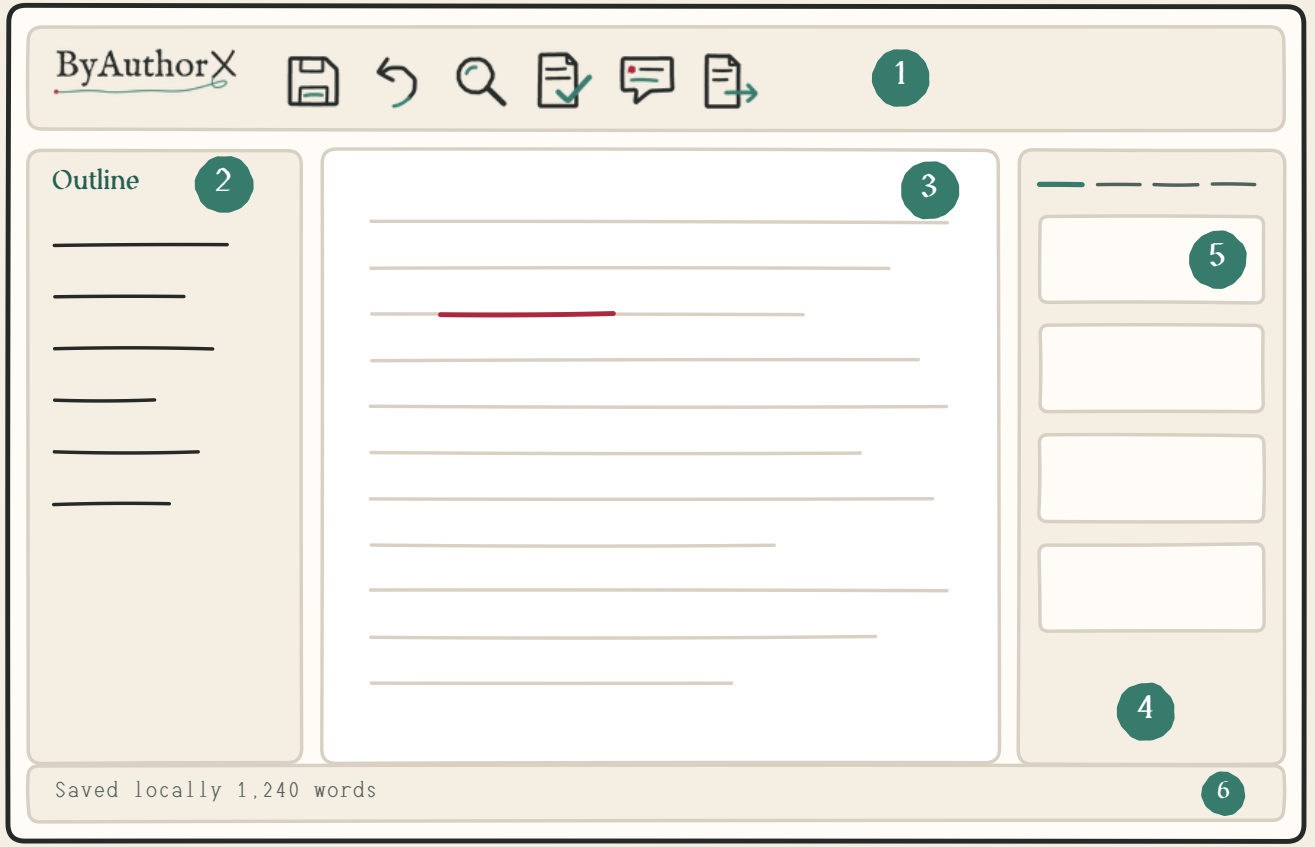
Hover a chip for the passage, click it to open the source at its page, then Insert as citation. Checks → Citation audit re-checks them all.




```
From the command line: byax route draft.byax --request '…' --inspect
```

Find your way around the window

A schematic of the editor. The writing page stays white inside warm paper margins.



1 Ribbon

Two rows of tools. Each file view shows only what its format supports.

2 Side panel

Choose Outline, Binder, Layout, Bookmarks, Statistics, Scratchpad or Library.

3 Writing view

Continuous editing. Switch to Pages for the layout print and PDF use.

4 Inspector

Proposed changes, Checks, AI and Configure.

5 Proposed changes

Every suggestion waits here. Run all active checks from this tab.

6 Status bar

Save state, counters and the limits of the current file format.

Your first minutes

Six steps from a fresh install to a first export, all on your own computer.

1



Take the tour

Six short steps. Reopen any time with Help → Take the tour…

2



Open the sample project

Help → Open sample project makes a copy of The Lamp at Harrow Point to practise on.

3



Write, then save

A .byax file keeps your text, images, review notes and history together.

4



Run the local checks

In Proposed changes, choose Run all active checks. Nothing leaves your computer.

5



Accept or reject

Each proposal waits for you. Keep what works.

6



Export a copy

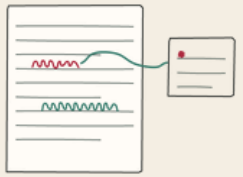
File → Export. The master is never replaced, and you see what a format left out.

Install: Windows 11 x64 setup, Ubuntu 24.04 x64 .deb, or macOS 14+ .dmg for Apple silicon. Installers may be unsigned; see troubleshooting.

Checks at a glance

Four kinds of check, what each starts as, and where it runs.

CHECK	STARTS	WHERE IT RUNS
On this computer Spelling, grammar, document health.	Active by default	Stays on your computer
Fiction analysis Dialogue tags, filter words, repeated openings, rhythm, sensory balance, invented-name spelling.	Inactive by default	Stays on your computer. Advisory.
Extension checks Added by extensions you install and enable under Tools → Extensions...	Inactive by default	Depends on the extension
With an AI provider Information repository, factual accuracy, voice consistency and checks you write.	Inactive by default	Asks for your authorization each time



Red pen marks spelling and green pen marks grammar. They are interface only and never appear in print or exports.

Results are proposals. Text changes only when you accept. Find the list in Inspector → Checks.

Your file, your copies

The master file holds everything. Every other format is a copy that says what it left out.

YOU WANT TO	DO THIS
Keep a master you can edit later	Save as .byax
Open Word, ODT, RTF, HTML, EPUB or text	File → Open. A report lists anything lost.
Share a PDF or Word copy	File → Export. The master is never replaced.
See how a format will look	Use the File view selector in the toolbar.
Publish an e-book	File → Export → EPUB.
Make a print book or a submission	File → Compile…

Hidden or unsupported content stays in the master. Word, ODT and RTF previews are approximate.

Private by default

Four claims, said the same way everywhere ByAuthorX speaks.

1. **No account**
   Nothing to sign up for. Write the day you install.

2. **No telemetry**
   ByAuthorX does not report how you use it.

3. **No background traffic**
   No update pings. Help → Check for updates asks once, when you click.

4. **Nothing leaves until you choose**
   AI sends nothing until you add a provider and press Send.



Hosted or local, you choose the provider. Keys stay in your OS keyring or a named environment variable.